

EY Fast-Growth Insights

Based on our survey data, this report from EY explores the challenges and opportunities facing fast-growth companies emerging from the pandemic.

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Will you overlook a fast-growth opportunity, or oversee it?

As the UK's cohort of fast-growth companies emerge from the pandemic, this report explores attitudes to post-pandemic recovery, along with the challenges and opportunities in growing their business.

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Preferred back offices locations
The extent to which COVID-19 impacted employee wellbeing and productivity
What this all means for the future of fast-growth companies

Here's a sneak-peak inside

Strong performance during the pandemic sets up a bright future

Companies need to capitalise on recent success to accelerate their growth

Fast-growth companies are emerging from the pandemic in a position of strength. They now have the opportunity to push on and drive their growth agendas. A total of 72% of fast-growth companies grew revenues during the pandemic and 22% grew revenues by more than 100%. During the pandemic, not all sectors fared equally with SaaS and Fintech seeing the highest growth, with 91% of companies experiencing upside to revenue and 20% upside of over 100%. The success of these sectors was driven by the rapid adoption of digital services by consumers and businesses as a result of the lockdowns and people working from home.

This success positions fast-growth companies to take advantage of the post-pandemic rebound. Levels of optimism are high, with 84% of respondents feeling positive about their company's growth prospects over the next 12 months. This confidence reflects both their digital DNA, which means not having legacies that might hold back more established companies and their ability to pivot to the new normal. Exploiting these advantages will enable them to grow market share.

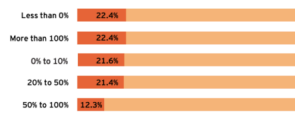
Optimistic prospects for revenue growth

How do you feel about the revenue prospects of your business over the next 12 months? % agree*



*Figures have been rounded to the nearest whole number.

What was the revenue growth of your business in the last 12 months?



*Figures have been rounded up to the nearest decimal place.

Fundraising remains a major challenge for founders

Widening the options provides more routes to financing growth

In light of the reluctance to exit and the desire to grow the business, attention naturally shifts to funding as a way to finance growth and investment. The challenge here is that 65% of respondents cite funding as representing the biggest constraint on growth and yet securing funding is a vital skill that all founders need to master. The single biggest obstacle, according to 63% of respondents, is simply finding suitable investors.

Founders need to explore the widest possible set of potential investors and funders. Currently, their horizons seem to be too narrow. While 92% are open to investors from the UK, only around half are considering investors from the US (52%) or Europe (49%) and just 12% are considering investors from Asia Pacific. In the current economic climate, founders should not be shying away from international options and should be actively looking at the alternatives.

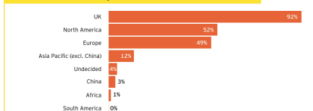
Challenges in fundraising



*Survey participants were able to select up to three options, meaning they may be represented in multiple options.

*Figures have been rounded to the nearest whole number.

Location of possible investors



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*Figures have been rounded to the nearest whole number.

If you work with high-growth UK companies, you need Beauhurst.

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